

Sextortion and Image Abuse



BIG IDEA Blackmail with intimate images, real or AI-made, is a known, scripted crime designed to work on anyone. It is never your fault. There is a clear plan, STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT, and help exists.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN Counselor and an administrator have the plan 5 school days ahead; counselor on site during and 2 hours after. Pre-notice done; opt-outs do “Pressure, Blackmail, and Account Threats” (R5-Alt). Reporting route in writing. Never teach it as a substitute.

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script Say it calm and low-key. “Three things up front. Nothing graphic will be shown or described. This is about what to do, and blame has no place in it. You can step out at any time without explaining. There is a scripted crime: someone pretends to be your age, builds a quick connection, gets a private image, and threatens to share it unless you pay. It is designed to work on smart, careful people, because it works on feelings. It is never the target’s fault. The plan has four words: Stop, Save, Tell, Report.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN The Response Drill

- 1 (2 min) Read the pattern.** A volunteer reads the fictional card (“Rowan, 16” and “Riley”). Underline: fast closeness, flattery, a push to a private app, “you first,” a sudden change of tone, a deadline, a payment demand, a threat to share, “do not tell anyone.” The script needs speed and shame.
- 2 (3 min) Fill in the drill on W5. STOP:** stop replying, do not pay, do not delete the account or chat. **SAVE:** details only (username, links, threats, dates), never an image. **TELL:** a trusted person tonight; try another adult if one reacts badly. **REPORT:** the platform; NCMEC CyberTipline (report.cybertip.org, 1-800-843-5678); Take It Down (takeitdown.ncmec.org); with an adult, law enforcement; 911 in an emergency.
- 3 (2 min) First sentence of TELL,** in pairs. A: “Something happened online and I need help. I am scared, and I do not want to be blamed.” B: “Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault. We will figure it out together.”
- 4 (1 min) The AI version.** Same plan. Sharing a sexual fake of a person is abuse and can be a crime. Hand out the Helpline Card.

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause the moment speed, flattery or secrecy begins. Check who they are, which you cannot. Tell, tonight. Stop, Save, Tell, Report. Add to your Defense Plan: “The one adult I would tell first is _____, and my first sentence is _____.”

Hand signal: Hackles up? Speed, flattery and secrecy are what hackles are for (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Telling is the way out. Stop, save details, tell, report. Tonight.”

EXIT TICKET “Write the four steps in your own words and the role of one person you would tell.”

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R5 Scenario Card, Drill Card and Helpline Card per student (opt-outs too), Workbook W5, four boxes on the board. No images, screenshots or devices.

- ☐ Helpline Cards printed; Question Box ready to review with the counselor.
- ☐ Opt-out supervisor and room arranged.
- ☐ Check in privately with anyone who left early or seemed upset.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why does the script need secrecy and speed?”
- 2** “What can an adult say in the first ten seconds that makes telling easier?”
- 3** “A friend says they are being threatened. What do you say, and what do you avoid?”

Keep it fictional. If a student starts their own story: “Let’s talk after class.”

FUN BOOST Myth or Plan (calm; no scoring).

Thumbs up (plan) or sideways (myth): “Paying will make it stop” (myth).

LEVEL-UP Write It Better. Draft three sentences a school could send explaining STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT without shame.

DIFFERENTIATE A pictured Drill Card, the TELL sentence on a card, and a small group with the counselor.

FAMILY CARD Say tonight: “If anything like this ever happens, you will not be in trouble with me. Tell me and we will handle it together.” Delete nothing and pay nothing; contact the platform, NCMEC and law enforcement.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault. The person who did this is responsible.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you send it?” or “How could you...?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Let me see.” Never view, copy or forward an image.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person and an administrator the same day; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law, and report to the NCMEC CyberTipline.